

SMRITI GANAPATHI

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EDUCATION

PhD. in Public Policy
Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago
📅 2027 (Expected) 📍 Chicago, USA

PhD scholarship by The Pearson Institute

- *Dissertation - "Enforcement, Norms, Framing: How Institutional Decisions Shape Gender-Based Violence"*

MSc. Economics and Social Sciences
Bocconi University
📅 2018 📍 Milan, Italy

Admitted with a merit scholarship.

- *Dissertation - "Tackling violence against women: can laws change perceptions?"*

GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- 2026; 2023: \$16,000, Development Economics Research Fund, University of Chicago & NHH – "Sexual Violence in South Africa".
- 2026: Center for Gender & Sexuality Studies Grant
- 2021: PhD scholarship by the Pearson Institute.
- 2021: \$3000, Research funds by the Pearson Institute.
- 2015: Merit scholarship for Master's degree by Bocconi University.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- *The Impact of Victim-Centric Institutions on Sex Offense Perpetration (JMP)* – with Daniela Horta-Saenz & Mazeeda Karani
- *Policing Intimate Partner Violence: Curbing Abuse or Shifting It?*
- *The Impact of Social Movements on Rape Rhetoric: Evidence from India*

POLICY WRITING

- Oeindrila Dube, Smriti Ganapathi, Soeren J. Henn, and James A. Robinson. 2020. "Farmer-Herder Conflict in Nigeria's Middle Belt: Evidence from 288 Communities." *Policy Report*.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Violence Prevention Research Conference
📅 July 12-14, 2026 📍 Portsmouth NH, USA

International Society for the Prevention of Child Abuse and Neglect (ISPCAN) Congress
📅 Oct 06-09, 2025 📍 Vilnius, Lithuania

European Conference on multi-agency response to gender-based violence
📅 May 16-17, 2019 📍 Vilnius, Lithuania

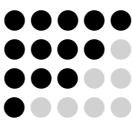
Second International Symposium on Gender, Law and Constitutions
📅 Apr 12-13, 2017 📍 Washington DC, USA

SOFTWARE SKILLS

R Stata Python LaTeX NVivo

LANGUAGES

English
Hindi & Tamil
Italian & French
Arabic & Hawaiian



TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor - Program Evaluation
University of Chicago
📅 Oct 2023 📍 Chicago, U.S.A

Designed and taught course for international policy students & practitioners.

Guest Lecturer: Violence in Schools
University of Chicago
📅 Feb 2026 📍 Chicago, U.S.A

Teaching Assistant
University of Chicago
📅 Oct 2022 – Mar 2026 📍 Chicago, U.S.A

Leading TA sessions & Office hours:

- Statistics for Data Analysis; Program Evaluation; Advanced Microeconomics

Supervising student research proposals:

- Education & Economic Development

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Research Assistant
University of Chicago
📅 Jun 2022 – Oct 2023 📍 Chicago, U.S.A

Projects related to domestic abuse, using causal machine learning.

Pre-doctoral Research Assistant
University of Chicago
📅 Jul 2019 – Jul 2021 📍 Chicago, U.S.A

Quasi-experimental projects & RCTs around conflict and gender.

Field Research Associate
Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)
📅 Jun 2018 – Dec 2018 📍 Chennai, India

RCT on women's and children's health, overseeing primary data collection from over 10,000 households in 223 villages

MULTILATERAL ORGANIZATIONS

Evaluation Intern
International Fund for Agricultural Development
📅 Mar 2019 – Jul 2019 📍 Rome, Italy

Synthesized findings from 30 projects on community-driven development (CDD).

Intern- Crime Statistics
UN Office on Drugs and Crime
📅 Jan 2018 – Apr 2018 📍 Vienna, Austria

Compiled global data on violence against women, and contributed to the "Global Study on Homicide" report.

PHD COURSEWORK

- Game Theory
- Advanced Microeconomics for Policy Analysis I & II
- Applied Econometrics I, II, & III
- Topics in Econometrics (a course on Machine Learning and Econometrics)
- Applied Microeconometrics
- The Practicalities of Running Randomized Control Trials
- Behavioral Economics - Development & Observational Data
- Behavioral Economics - Theory & the Lab
- Gender & Policy
- Understanding Inequality as a Psychologist
- Advanced Topics in Political Economy: Comparing Societies

REFERENCES

- Oeindrila Dube: odube@uchicago.edu
- Chris Blattman: blattman@uchicago.edu
- Anjali Adukia: adukia@uchicago.edu